

1.5 IQR

Why is 1.5 Used in the IQR Formula?

- The factor 1.5 was introduced by the statistician John Turkey and has become a standard rule in statistics.
- It provides a balance between detecting unusual observations and avoiding the incorrect classification of normal values as outliers.
- If smaller number like 1 is multiplied then many normal observations might be incorrectly identified as outliers.
- If larger number like 2 or 3 is multiplied it would fail to detect some truly extreme values.
- Therefore 1.5 provides an effective compromise and has become widely accepted in statistical analysis.

